

30 Rules for Getting Rich

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Executive Summary

Brandon Carter delivers 30 concise, actionable rules for getting rich — spanning business fundamentals, income strategy, mindset, mentorship, and productivity habits aimed at accelerating financial independence.

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Income & Business Strategy Rules 0:00

- **Stop trading time for money**
 - The classic employee model caps your earnings at the hours you can physically work — break out of it
- Focus on active income before worrying about passive income
 - Passive income requires capital or systems that first need to be built from active earnings
- Make sure your business is always solving problems that people **already pay for**
 - Don't try to create demand from scratch; find existing demand and serve it
- Sell just one thing until you're making at least **\$10K a month**
 - Spreading across multiple offers dilutes focus; master one product/service first
- Keep your day job until your side hustle is making at least **2× your job income**
 - Removes financial pressure and lets you make smarter, less desperate business decisions
- Ask for a raise or raise your prices
 - "Nobody's going to give you more money unless you ask for it" — proactive negotiation is required
- Buy assets instead of liabilities
 - Assets generate or hold value; liabilities drain money — direct purchases accordingly

Know Your Numbers 0:00

- Know **all** your key business metrics at all times
 - Operating cash flow — how much cash the business generates from operations
 - Net burn rate — how fast you're spending through reserves
 - Cost of customer acquisition (CAC) — what it costs to win each new customer
 - Lifetime value (LTV) — total revenue a customer generates over their relationship with you
- Prioritize your days around tasks that make you the most money
 - Time is the constraint; allocate it to highest-revenue-generating activities first

Skills, Learning & Mentorship 0:21

- Focus all your free time on **learning and mastering a high income skill**
 - High income skills (sales, copywriting, coding, marketing, etc.) directly increase earning capacity
- Record and study all your sales calls the way athletes study game tape
 - Reviewing calls reveals patterns in objections, missed closes, and language that works
 - Athletes don't just practice — they analyze performance to improve; apply same discipline to sales
- **Pay for mentors** — described as "the fastest way to shorten your learning curve"
 - A mentor compresses years of trial-and-error into months by sharing what already works
- Get around rich people because they can teach you things that shorten your learning curve
 - Environment shapes mindset, expectations, and access to information and opportunities
- Don't take advice from poor people
 - Advice reflects the advisor's results — seek guidance only from those who have achieved what you want
- Learn how to sell
 - Selling is the single skill that underlies all business and income growth; non-negotiable

Productivity & Focus 0:21

- Anything you do more than **three times a week**, teach someone (or an agent/system) how to handle it
 - Repetitive tasks are automatable or delegatable — your time should move up the value chain
- Put your phone in the other room while you're working
 - Physical separation removes the temptation and the reflex to check it
- Check your screen time on your phone to see how much time you're actually wasting
 - Most people underestimate phone usage; the data makes the cost of distraction concrete
- Post every day on social media
 - "I don't care what kind of business you are in, people are always going to search your social media first"
 - Social presence is now a default trust signal — neglecting it costs credibility
- Build an audience before you need it

- Growing an audience takes time; start before you have something to sell so the audience is ready when you do

Wealth Building & Investing 0:66

- Invest at least **20% of your income**
 - Consistent investing — regardless of amount — builds the compounding base for long-term wealth
- Buy assets instead of liabilities
 - Reinforces directing money toward things that grow or generate returns, not things that depreciate or cost ongoing money

Mindset & Discipline Rules 0:45

- Sleep at least **7 hours a night**
 - "You can't make good decisions when you're [sleep] shot" — cognitive performance is directly tied to recovery
- Don't tell anybody your goals
 - "This way, if you fail or change your mind, nobody knows" — removes social pressure and ego from the equation
 - Sharing goals can also create a false sense of accomplishment before the work is done
- Don't wait until you're ready to start
 - "You'll never feel ready because being ready is not a feeling" — readiness comes from doing, not waiting
- Always remember that **nobody is coming to save you**
 - Full personal accountability — external rescue (employer, government, family) is not a strategy
- Stop comparing your chapter 3 to someone else's chapter 30
 - Comparing your early stage to someone else's advanced stage is demotivating and misleading
 - Everyone's timeline is different; irrelevant comparisons stall progress

"You'll never feel ready because being ready is not a feeling." — The core mindset shift: action precedes confidence, not the other way around.